

WHAT DOES LIVING IN CHRIST LOOK LIKE?

The New Life Takes Root and Becomes Visible

The believer lives from Christ through the Spirit and increasingly displays Christ's life as rooted fruit.



BIG IDEA

Christ's life takes root and becomes visible through Spirit-enabled growth and fruit.

KEY SCRIPTURE

John 15:1-11

ALSO READ

Galatians 5:16-25

MEMORY VERSE

GALATIANS 5:25

"If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit."

MAIN QUESTION

How Does Christ's New Life Become Visible?

45 MINUTES

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SESSION SNAPSHOT



SESSION GOALS

- Live from Christ rather than trying to manufacture spiritual life.
- See the Spirit as the source of growth and fruit.
- Understand the place of Scripture, prayer, church, and obedience.
- Practice service and witness as grateful fruit, not payment.

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OPENING ACTIVITY: "ROOT OR FRUIT?"

1

DRAW A SIMPLE PLANT (2 MIN)

Draw roots, a stem, branches, and fruit. Ask which parts supply life and which parts show that life is present.

2

NAME THE SOURCE (2 MIN)

Read John 15:5. The branch does not create life by producing fruit. It bears fruit because its life comes from the vine.

3

PLACE THE PRACTICES (2 MIN)

Write Scripture, prayer, church, obedience, service, and witness. They are ways believers receive, express, and share life in Christ - not ways to purchase it.

4

TEST THE ORDER (2 MIN)

Ask what goes wrong when someone tries to use Christian activity to become alive or to make God keep him. Keep root before fruit.

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LEADER GUARDRAIL

Do not turn spiritual practices into conditions for creating, purchasing, or preserving salvation. Believers obey because they are alive in Christ. Abiding describes continuing dependence and fellowship; it does not mean keeping oneself joined to Christ by sufficient effort.

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PREPARE

- Bible
- Board or paper
- Root-and-fruit sketch
- Student handouts
- Plan next-step conversations

Good works are the fruit of Christ's life, never the root or price of it.

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B CORE TEACHING

1 LIVE FROM CHRIST, THE TRUE VINE John 15:1-11

The believer does not graduate from dependence upon Christ. His Word, love, and life shape the branch so that fruit appears.

EMPHASIZE: Fruit reveals received life; it does not create union.

2 WALK BY THE SPIRIT Gal. 5:16-25

The Spirit opposes the desires of the flesh and produces Christlike character. Growth is active dependence, not passive waiting or self-powered reform.

EMPHASIZE: The same Spirit who gives life enables the believer's walk.

3 GROW WITH CHRIST'S PEOPLE Acts 2:41-47

Baptism, Scripture, prayer, fellowship, the Lord's Supper, worship, and mutual care belong to ordinary Christian life in the church.

EMPHASIZE: New life is personal, but it was never designed to be solitary.

4 SERVE AND BEAR WITNESS Eph. 2:8-10

Grace creates a people prepared for good works. Service and witness make Christ's life visible and carry His Gospel toward others.

EMPHASIZE: Works are God's appointed fruit, never the purchase price of grace.

? DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1 Why can't a branch manufacture its own life?

Follow-up: What does Jesus mean by abiding in Him?

2 How is walking by the Spirit both dependent and active?

Follow-up: What is different from self-improvement?

3 Why does new life belong in a local church?

Follow-up: Which practices in Acts 2 were shared?

4 How do good works display grace without earning it?

Follow-up: Which comes first in Ephesians 2?

5 Which practice needs a faithful next step this week?

Follow-up: Who can help you take it?

! WEEKLY CHALLENGE

Choose one rooted practice and one outward fruit for the next seven days.

- Rooted practice: Scripture, prayer, or church
- Outward fruit: obedience, service, or witness

7 A ROOTED WEEK

SCRIPTURE

hear Christ's Word

PRAYER

depend upon God

CHURCH

share the life

OBEDIENCE

receive His authority

SERVICE

give for others

WITNESS

speak of Christ

+ PRIVATE CONVERSATION

Help a new believer identify concrete next steps in baptism, church life, Scripture, and prayer. If a student is still outside Christ, return to the Gospel rather than assigning Christian habits as a substitute for conversion.

N LEADER NOTES

- Christ remains the source.
- The Spirit enables growth.
- Church life is ordinary, not optional.
- Practice serves relationship.
- Fruit never becomes price.

Because we live in the Spirit, we also walk in the Spirit.